

and annual charges collected from the operators.

"The group of ministers will decide on the timing and what to auction, but we are expecting around Rs 300 billion next year," said Sushma Nath, finance secretary, at a press conference after the presentation of the budget by the finance minister.

## Apple, Samsung and Nokia come under scanner

After BlackBerry, the Indian government has set up a technical committee to scan similar services from Apple, Samsung and Nokia for their lawful interception to check whether these players conform to the security monitoring requirements.

"The solution or action will depend on the nature and architecture of the service and the gravity of need felt by the security agency," reads an internal note by the government.

The move followed after Canadian smartphone maker Research In Motion (RIM) appealed that it should not be singled out as Apple, Motorola, Nokia, Samsung, HTC and Sony Ericsson also use strong encryption in their smartphones.

In the case of BlackBerry, the government is still unsatisfied with the solutions offered by the Canadian company to monitor BlackBerry Messenger.

## Canon to sell 100,000 digital SLRs this year

Canon India expects to sell 100,000 units of its high-end digital single-lens reflex (SLR) cameras this calendar year. "The notion that India is a cost-sensitive market is not fully right. People out here want to enjoy modern life, and are ready to pay for value. They are upgrading from consumer cameras to SLRs," opined Kensaku Konishithe, president and chief executive, Canon India.

## Nikon launches new cameras

Nikon India has launched ten new cameras under its latest COOLPIX

Spring Series 2011. These cameras come with advanced features in 39 brilliant colours, and are competitively priced between Rs 4990 and Rs 26,950.

"We have already built up a strong position with around 20 per cent market share in compact cameras. As a leading brand in India, we are planning to expand the market share to 25 per cent in the coming fiscal year 2011-12, with the introduction of ten new cameras," said Hiroshi Takashina, managing director, Nikon India.

## LG strengthens B2B segment in Gujarat

LG Electronics India has launched an LED-backlit LCD network monitor with Gujarati and Hindi on-screen display and commercial-grade LCD monitors for Gujarat market.

"With these new varied offerings, we intend to offer solutions to various needs of the Indian consumers through the perfect harmony of smart technology and stylish design. We plan to introduce more customised products across India. Certainly, education is a key area for India and such products will contribute in improving the efficiency in education and business segment," said Dr Y.V.Verma, chief operating officer, LG Electronics India.

## HP may stop production at Pantnagar plant

Computer maker Hewlett Packard (HP) is planning to close production at its Pantnagar plant. The Union Budget 2011-12 has proposed to levy a 5 per cent excise duty on major PC components including microprocessors, DVD writers, CD writers, floppy disk drives and flash drives—all of which were previously exempted from excise duty. These components together account for 30-40 per cent of the cost of a PC. The increase, accord-



Nikon COOLPIX L110 digital camera

ing to HP, has led to imported desktops and laptops costing less than products manufactured in India.

## Aircel to invest Rs 230 billion in 2G and 3G

Aircel is set to invest about Rs 230 billion in 2G and 3G operations in the next three-four years. This will take the company's cumulative investment in India by then to around Rs 450 billion.

"We are excited about 3G, as we see it as something that will begin to transform our lives in many ways. The youth comprise over 50 per cent of Indian population and are among active Internet users and also avid users of Facebook, YouTube and other social networking sites. The launch of 3G services on Aircel will address the high-speed digital needs of the consumers," said Gurdeep Singh, chief operating officer, Aircel.

## Western Digital to acquire Hitachi GST

Western Digital (WD) is acquiring Hitachi Global Storage Technologies (Hitachi GST), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Hitachi, for \$4.3 billion. The resulting company will retain the Western Digital name and remain headquartered in Irvine, California.

John Coyne will continue to be the chief executive officer of WD, Tim Leyden chief operating officer and Wolfgang Nickl chief financial officer. Steve Milligan, president and chief executive officer of Hitachi GST, will join WD as president, reporting to John Coyne.

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